

DOES THIS SECTION EVEN NEED AN INTRODUCTION? FROM COMPUTERS TO MOBILES, AND HEADPHONES TO GPUs, IT'S ALL HERE...

THIS MONTH IN TECH:
The few companies that make most of your smartphone, how to become a bug bounty hunter, defence startups in India, and how to get the most of music streaming services such as Spotify and YouTube Music.



Facebook getting data from third-party apps

Even if you directly don't share data with Facebook it'll still get access to your sensitive data from third-party apps. Data such as the user's heart rate, intent to get pregnant, etc. is obtained via Facebook's analytics SDK that's used by third-party apps.
<https://dgit.in/fbdta>

WHAT'S NEW

Google unveils new game streaming platform - Stadia

Even before GDC 2019, one of the biggest hype generators was Google with its upcoming game streaming platform. Stadia is a multi-faceted platform by Google which aims to bring developers, gamers and content creators together. Project Stream, which was demonstrated publicly last October was just one facet of what Stadia was being set up to be. With 7500+ edge nodes, i.e. client-facing data centre nodes, Google is effectively making latency a thing of the past so that gamers can simply play a supported game within seconds of coming across a link anywhere on Google's



services. Google's starting off with 1080p 60 FPS game streams in beta with 4K support being available when the service launches later

this year. Moreover, Google's also making 8K resolution available for those who need it. The GPU and CPU that powers each instance was custom developed by AMD and is reportedly more powerful than the current gen consoles from Sony and Microsoft. <https://dgit.in/stadia>

Crytek demonstrates real-time ray-tracing on Radeon RX Vega 56

Crytek's new Neon Noir showcases real-time ray-tracing on an AMD Radeon RX Vega 64. The caveat here is that it was made using a bespoke version of the Crytek 5.5 game engine which means that not every studio can use it unless Crytek incorporates it into an update to the main branch. Close on the heels of this announcement, NVIDIA came



out with its plans on enabling real-time ray-tracing features on their graphics cards which they'd claimed were inefficient

at doing so. The AMD Radeon Vega 56 is nearly two years old and could run the demo smoothly. However, this is not indicative of its performance with games that have real-time ray-tracing since there are a lot more factors at play. Nevertheless, this is a good demonstration of what is possible with existing hardware.
<https://dgit.in/crytekrtr>



Apple silently refreshes iPad and iMac

Apple silently refreshed the iPad Air, iPad Mini and the iMac. While the iMac was spruced up with the new Intel 8th and 9th Gen CPUs and Radeon Pro and Vega 20 GPUs, the iPad Air is now available in a larger 10.5-inch format.
<https://dgit.in/2019mac>



Boeing to address 737 MAX issue

The reason for the two Boeing 737 Max crashes squarely pointing towards the faulty Maneuvering Characteristics Augmentation System (MCAS) which led to the system auto-correcting all corrective compensations performed by pilots.
<https://dgit.in/boeingfix>



Amazon-branded products are flops

A study by Marketplace Pulse that examined 23,000 products on Amazon found that buyers are not inclined to purchase Amazon-branded products even if they were elevated in search results, showing that Amazon is unable to leverage its clout.
<https://dgit.in/amznfail>